THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 9 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL MCQ TEST SET 3

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–8) | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–50 are Multiple Choice Questions (1 mark each); there is no negative marking.
3. Choose the correct option and write its letter (a, b, c or d) against the question number.
4. Questions cover the whole syllabus of the class.
5. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS 50 × 1 = 50

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which of these is an assumption behind Dr Malik's advice? 1

(a) luck decides all
(b) age matters most
(c) money is everything
(d) mindset can change what a person achieves

2. What does Shruti's violin symbolise? 1

(a) a trophy
(b) a link between Indian and global traditions
(c) a weapon
(d) wealth

3. What is implied by saying a letter can be a 'lifeline'? 1

(a) it is a rope for climbing
(b) it is a rope
(c) it can sustain emotional and economic survival
(d) it is decoration

4. Which of these is the best inference about Ming's state of mind? 1

(a) she is fearless **(b)** she is excited but uncertain
(c) she is angry **(d)** she is hopeless

5. Which alternative title would best preserve the story's theme? 1

(a) A Dreadful Serial **(b)** The Cost of a Novel
(c) A Teacher at Any Age **(d)** A Journey to Kashi

6. In 'gifts of grace', the alliteration is in the repeated sound: 1

(a) f **(b)** g **(c)** s **(d)** t

7. In 'A painting that stays', the poet hints at: 1

(a) the end of art
(b) permanence of nature's beauty compared to art
(c) a stolen picture
(d) loss of colours

8. In the poem, 'I cannot remember' paradoxically introduces: 1

(a) a lesson **(b)** forgetfulness only
(c) a series of memories **(d)** a denial of love

9. Which of the following is a likely theme shared by the unit? 1

(a) travel **(b)** trade
(c) redefining success **(d)** fear

10. Which technique most strongly builds emotional effect in a poem of praise? 1

(a) footnotes **(b)** dialogue
(c) statistics **(d)** accumulating metaphors

11. The relationship between 'carrier' and 'word' in the unit is: 1

(a) the carrier is unimportant
(b) the word is unimportant
(c) the quality of the message depends on the carrier and the content
(d) neither matters

12. A 'comfort zone' differs from a 'safe zone' in that comfort zone: 1

(a) is a place **(b)** limits growth though it feels safe
(c) is dangerous **(d)** is unreal

13. Which tense is used in 'By next Dassara, she will have read ten books'? 1

(a) present continuous **(b)** simple future
(c) past perfect **(d)** future perfect

14. The author of 'Quality' uses the narrator as: 1

(a) a witness with a conscience **(b)** a judge
(c) a villain **(d)** a comic figure

15. 'Artisanal' is an adjective meaning: 1

(a) ancient **(b)** large
(c) made by skilled hands **(d)** made in a factory

16. An appropriate heading for a newspaper column on this story is: 1

(a) Fog Delays Flights **(b)** Rain Delays Train
(c) Who Needs Vitamin-M Really? **(d)** Floods Hit the Coast

17. The word 'inclusive' is closest in meaning to: 1

(a) fast **(b)** open to all **(c)** closed to some **(d)** loud

18. The best summary of the unit is: 1

(a) music is loud
(b) music needs silence
(c) music bridges generations and heals the heart
(d) music is a business

19. Which expression best describes Khetaram: 'a tower of strength'? 1

(a) a building **(b)** a source of support
(c) a rich man **(d)** a tall man

20. Which statement is a rhetorical question? 1

(a) Who would not want to follow a dream? **(b)** Did she write?
(c) Where is Ming? **(d)** What time is it?

21. A reader says: 'The story shows teaching is a gift only the young can give.' This is: 1

(a) fully supported **(b)** not supported by the story
(c) a quotation **(d)** a title

22. A critic says the story is anti-modern. A fair reply is that it: 1

(a) ignores work
(b) praises machines
(c) opposes all change
(d) values tradition while accepting a girl's right to choose her work

23. Which sentence best captures the writer's stance? 1

(a) Fans are modern. **(b)** Progress is a mistake.
(c) Progress should not erase heritage. **(d)** Heritage is worthless.

24. 'Vitamin-M' is a good title chiefly because it: 1

(a) makes readers expect one thing and delivers another
(b) names a hero
(c) gives the setting
(d) names a medicine

25. What is the most likely reason the text uses an interview rather than a biography? 1

(a) to let the subject frame her own story **(b)** to entertain
(c) to save space **(d)** to avoid facts

26. 'Purity' in art is a debatable idea because: 1

(a) art never changes
(b) nobody cares
(c) traditions themselves evolved by borrowing
(d) purity is cheap

27. What does the postman's reading of letters reveal about literacy in the village? 1

(a) no interest **(b)** great learning
(c) gaps in access to education **(d)** good schools

28. A critic says the letter is conservative. A fair reply is that it: 1

(a) encourages bold dreaming while insisting on realism
(b) mocks effort
(c) forbids dreams
(d) ignores Ming

29. 'Peerless' and 'matchless' are: 1

(a) homonyms **(b)** antonyms **(c)** synonyms **(d)** homophones

30. A phrase that expresses unequal reward for skill is: 1

(a) fair wage **(b)** free time
(c) undervalued labour **(d)** higher education

31. 'Transient' beauty differs from 'lasting' beauty in that it: 1

(a) stays forever **(b)** fades quickly **(c)** is cheap **(d)** is false

32. A reader who calls the poem 'sentimental' may be answered by pointing to its: 1

(a) humour **(b)** loud language
(c) violence **(d)** restraint and simple images

33. A 'pyrrhic victory' is a win that comes at a heavy cost. The runners' finish is unlike it because it: 1

(a) is a draw **(b)** costs everything
(c) costs nothing and gains joy **(d)** ends in loss

34. What is the effect of using the first person in a poem about a friend? 1

(a) distance **(b)** intimacy **(c)** confusion **(d)** anger

35. Which statement links the two pieces? 1

(a) Communication is a moral act as well as a practical one
(b) Deserts need rain
(c) Postmen write poems
(d) Words are cheap

36. Which pair best shows the unit's central tension? 1

(a) rich vs poor **(b)** town vs village
(c) day vs night **(d)** security vs aspiration

37. Choose the sentence with correct subject-verb agreement: 1

(a) Neither the grandmother nor the children were late.
(b) Neither the grandmother nor the children was late.
(c) Neither grandmother nor children is late yesterday.
(d) Neither were the grandmother late.

38. 'Mass production' contrasts with: 1

(a) trade **(b)** money **(c)** handicraft **(d)** advertising

39. The prefix in 'rediscover' means: 1

(a) again **(b)** under **(c)** before **(d)** not

40. The best summary of Grandpa is: 1

(a) a sick man
(b) a lost traveller
(c) an elder whose wit outpaces the family's worry
(d) an angry guest

41. The most apt heading for a newspaper editorial on this unit is: 1

(a) Winning at Any Cost **(b)** A Rainy Day
(c) The Price of Fuel **(d)** Redefining the Finish Line

42. The words 'resonance' and 'harmony' are best linked by: 1

(a) conflict **(b)** distance
(c) noise **(d)** agreement of sound or feeling

43. 'Ephemeral' is a good word to describe: 1

(a) a stone **(b)** a mountain
(c) a fleeting spoken word **(d)** a sacred book

44. Which of the following is a counterexample to 'only the talented succeed'? 1

(a) a sudden win
(b) a persistent learner who masters a skill by practice
(c) a lazy genius
(d) a lost map

45. Why might the author mention the deadline and the festival together? 1

(a) to show hurry **(b)** to describe food
(c) to link learning with a sacred occasion **(d)** to show anger

46. In 'Quality', 'a man of quality' is best understood as one who: 1

(a) is famous **(b)** puts excellence before gain
(c) dresses finely **(d)** is rich

47. 'Cultural erosion' in this context means: 1

(a) an earthquake **(b)** sand storms
(c) trade growth **(d)** gradual loss of traditions

48. If the story were told from Grandpa's point of view, the main change would be: 1

(a) the story would be longer
(b) his dignity and feelings would be central
(c) Mother would vanish
(d) Ravi would be taller

49. Which of the following is an implicit message of the text? 1

(a) inclusion needs both individual grit and social change
(b) disability is rare
(c) success comes without effort
(d) medals are all

50. Which is the best interpretation of the title? 1

(a) two radio channels
(b) two different melodies producing one harmony, as father and daughter do
(c) two prizes
(d) two songs competing

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 50 Marks**

MASTERMIND